Gamma-ray burst classification

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Introduction to Bayesian probability theory

21/04/2026

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The Gamma Ray Bursts (GRBs)

They are transient events of high energy photons and extragalactic origin, discovered in 1973

They are usually composed of a first peak (prompt emission) and then an afterglow

We will use two proprieties to classify them:

- The T_{90}: the time needed to pass from 5% to 95% of the total flux of the prompt emission

- The HR: the ratio between fluxes in different energy bands

Tipical light curve of a GRB?
Or artistic representation?

Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: data

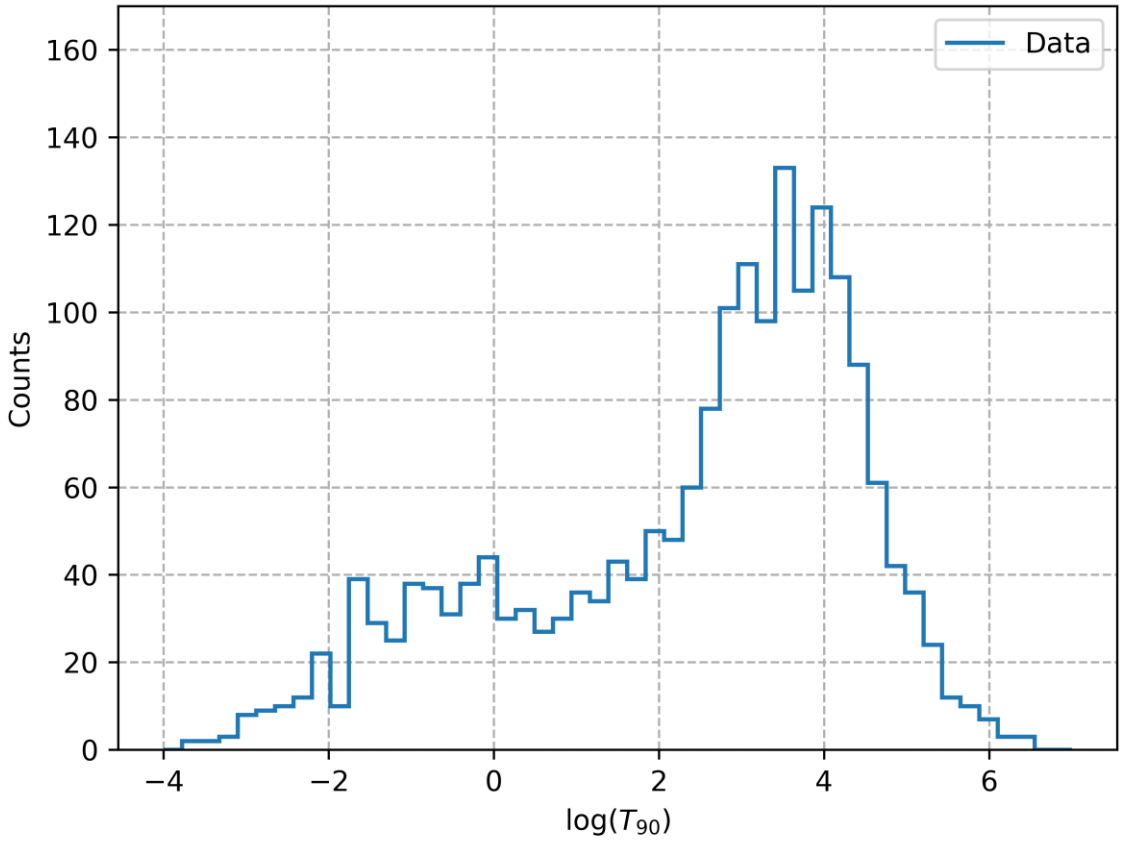
Dataset: 1932 burst seen by BATSE with the recorded $\log(T_{90})$, associated error and $\log(HR)$

Histogram on $\log(T_{90})$

Smallest value: ~ -3.7
Biggest value: ~ 6.5

50 bins from -4 to 7

Mean error is: 0.174
Median error is: 0.0919
A bin is large 0.224



Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: model

The model for the classification is the weighted sum of two log normal distribution

$$p(\log(T_{90})) = w\, N(\log(T_{90})\,|\mu_1\sigma_1) + (1-w)\, N(\log(T_{90})\,|\mu_2\sigma_2)$$

So we have 5 parameters to estimate, we will call them $\theta \equiv [w,\, \mu_1,\, \sigma_1,\, \mu_2,\, \sigma_2]$

Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: Bayes theorem

To estimate the parameters we will use Bayes theorem, define the propositions

- θ = «The set of parameters is θ»
- D = «The dataset we are analysing»
- H = «Model of the two weighted sum log normal»
- I = «All the background information on GRBs»

$$P(\theta|HDI) = P(\theta|HI)\frac{P(D|\theta HI)}{P(D|HI)}$$

Or in the log form:

$$\log P\,(\theta|HDI) = \log P\,(\theta|HI) + \log P\,(D|\theta HI) - \log P\,(D|HI)$$

Log prior — Log likelihood — Normalization costant

Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: Prior

$P(\theta|HI)$ Probability for a set of parameters given the model and background. Outside of the bounds is zero, inside?

For the weight and the means we chose a uniform prior

$$0 < w < 1$$

$$-4 < \mu_i < 7$$

$$Prior \propto 1$$

For the sigmas we chose a Jeffrey's prior because this are scale parameters of the problem

$$0.01 < \sigma_i < 3$$

$$Prior \propto 1/\sigma$$

Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: Likelihood

$P(D|\theta HI)$ Probability of seeing the dataset given a set of parameters, the model and background

Having the model, the parameters and the bins we can compute the predicted count in a bin by our model

$$\lambda_b = N \cdot p(\log(T_{90})_b\,|\theta) \cdot db$$

The probability of having the count c_b in a bin given the predicted count λ_b is the Poisson's distribution

$$P(c_b|\lambda_b) = \frac{1}{c_b!}\lambda_b^{c_b} e^{-\lambda_b}$$

The likelihood is the sum over all the bins!

$$P(D|\theta HI) = \sum_b P(c_b|\theta HI)$$

Sample the posterior: Metropolis-Hasting

Given a set of parameters we can now compute the posterior. How we find the set that maximize it?

5D grid search: not smart

Metropolis-Hasting algorithm!

$q(\theta)$ is the proposal distribution

We chose a 5D multivariate gaussian but how we chose his covariance matrix?

- «Blind» run: we use a diagonal covariance matrix with elements equals to 5% of the bound
- «Not Blind» run: we use a covariance matrix estimated after a previous run

Base idea

- Sample a θ_t from $q(\theta_0)$

Sample the posterior: Metropolis-Hasting

Given a set of parameters we can now compute the posterior. How we find the set that maximize it?

5D grid search: not smart

Metropolis-Hasting algorithm!

Acceptance rule:

$$\frac{p(\theta_t)}{p(\theta_0)} \cdot \frac{q(\theta_t|\theta_0)}{q(\theta_0|\theta_t)} \geq a$$

Posterior values

Proposal probability ratio
ours is symmetric so it's one

Random number
from [0,1]

Base idea

- Sample a θ_t from $q(\theta_0)$
- Compute the posterior on θ_t
- Check acceptance rule

Sample the posterior: Metropolis-Hasting

Given a set of parameters we can now compute the posterior. How we find the set that maximize it?

5D grid search: not smart

Metropolis-Hasting algorithm!

We make a first «blind» run of the algorithm with 10k steps to estimate the covariance

We then make the final run with 100k steps

Base idea

- Sample a θ_t from $q(\theta_0)$
- Compute the posterior on θ_t
- Check acceptance rule

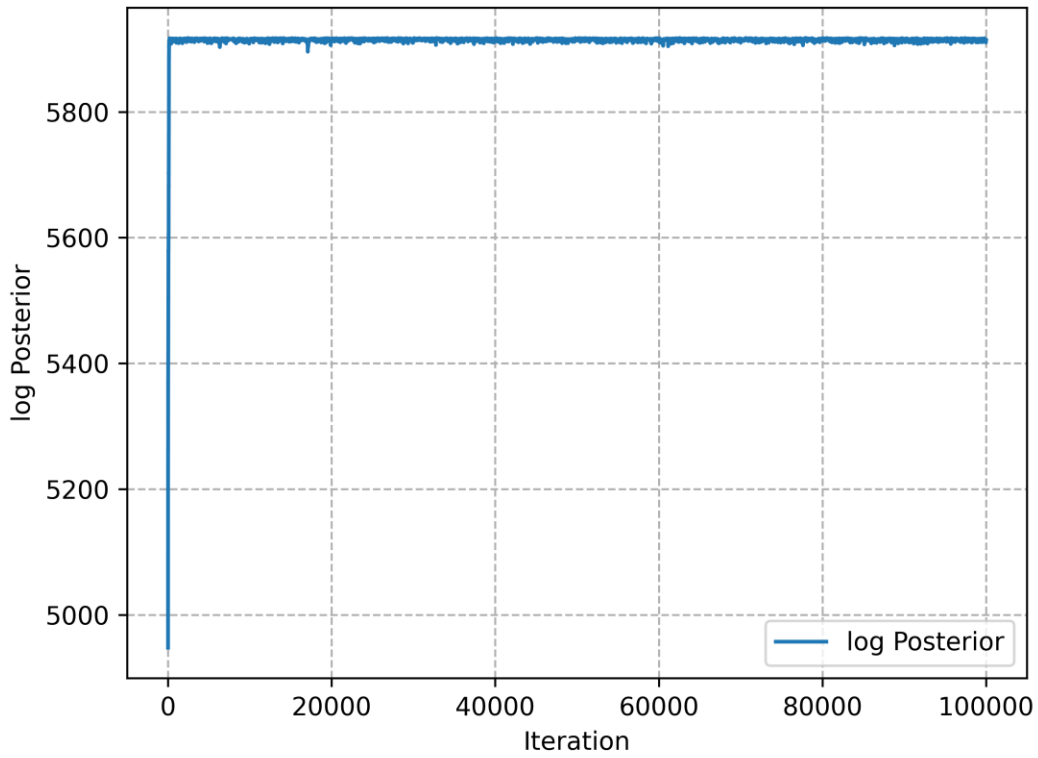
If true move to $\theta_0 = \theta_t$

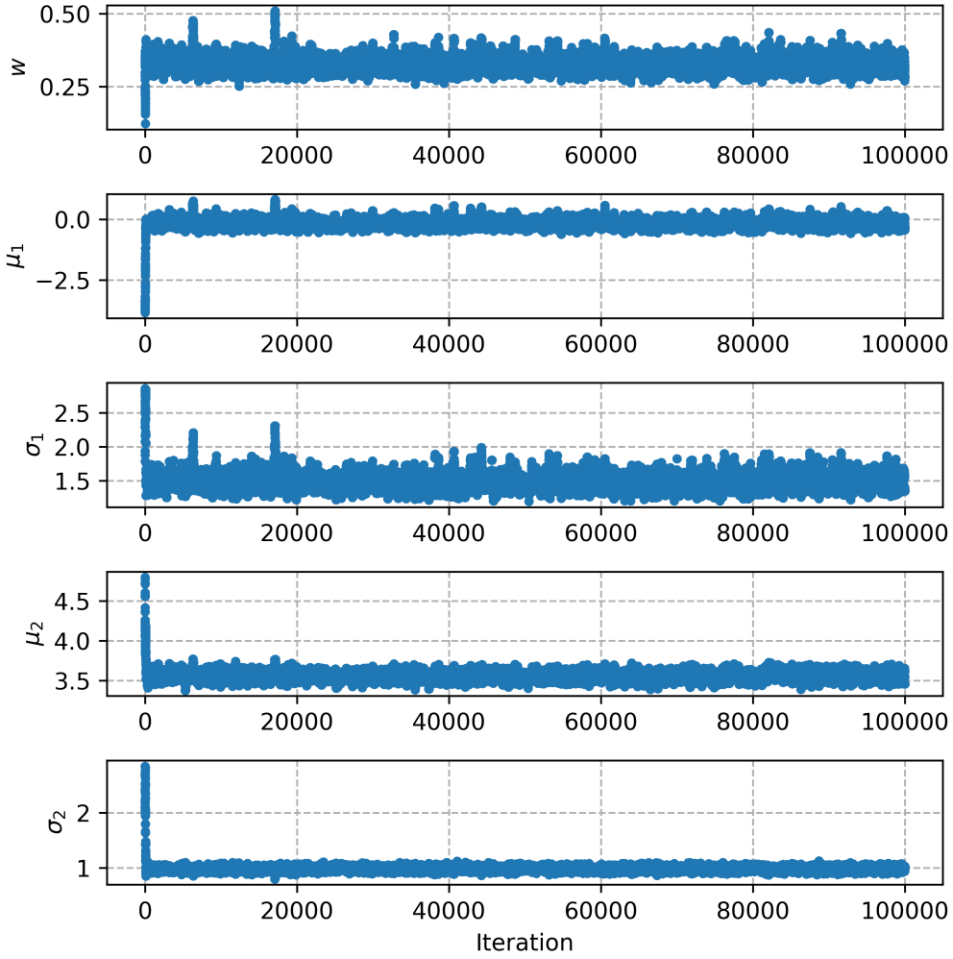
If false stay at θ_0

In this way we will have the θ with higher posterior more times so more probable!

Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: traces

We see that some steps are needed to find the peak → Burn-in: discard n points to have samples of the peak

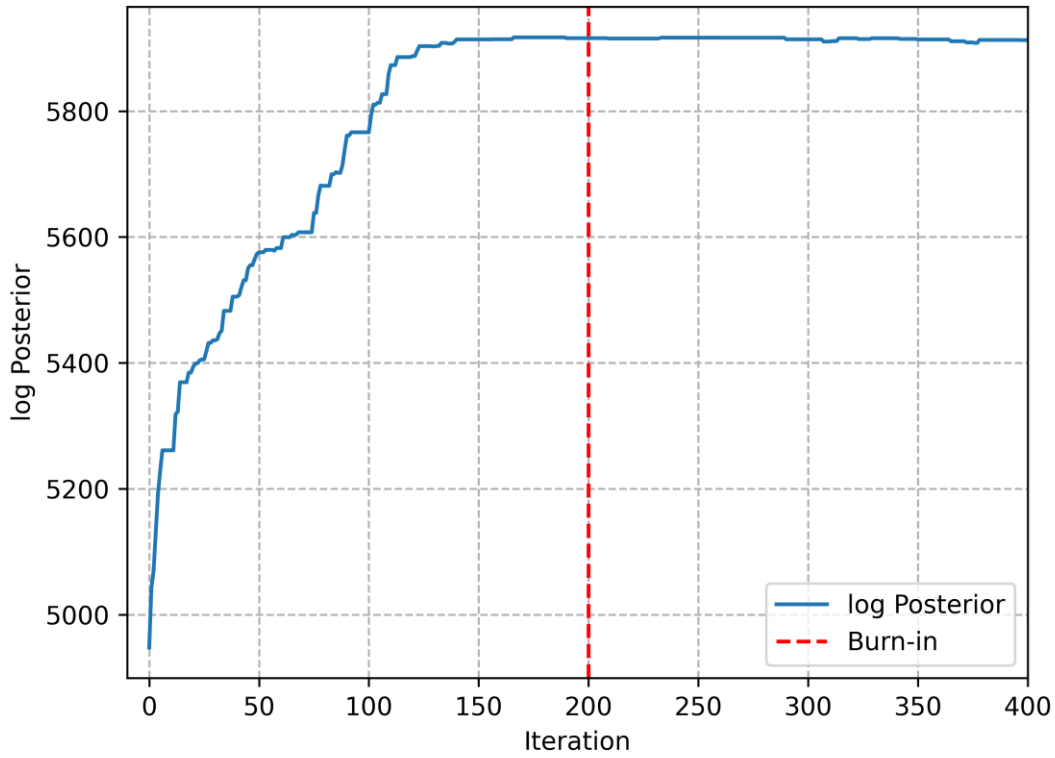


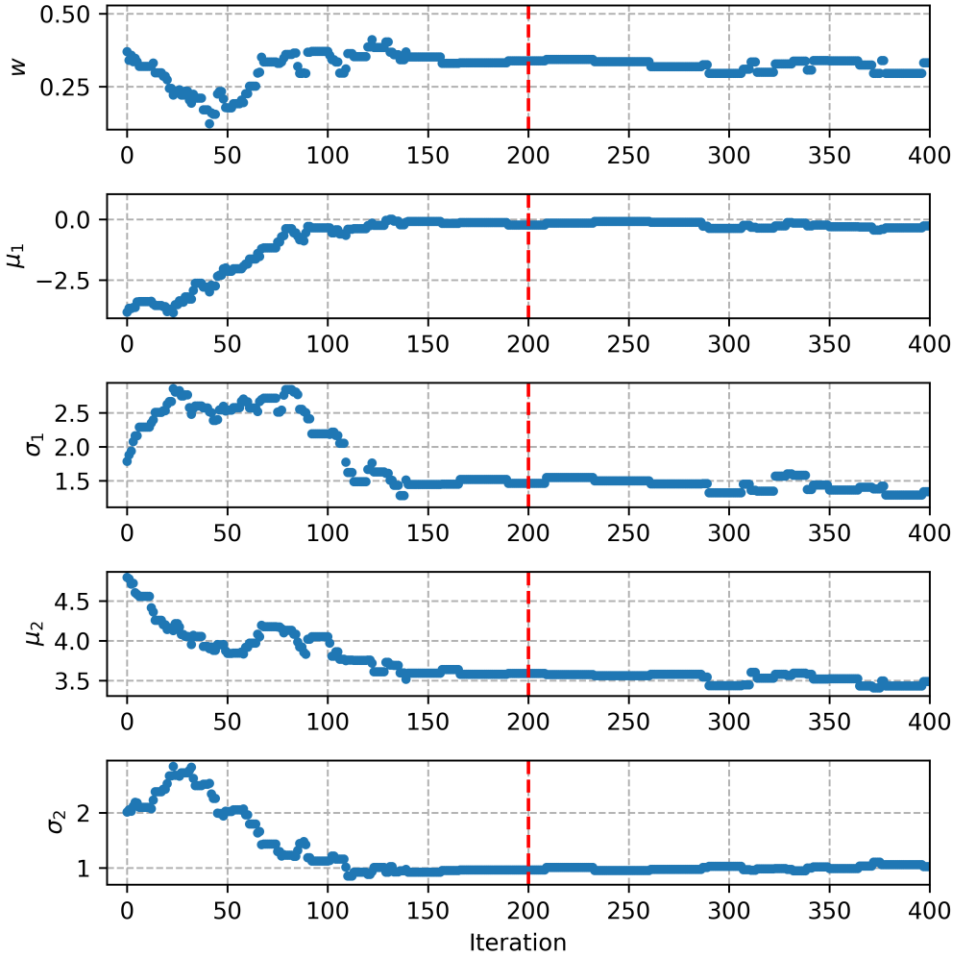


Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: traces

We see that some steps are needed to find the peak → Burn-in: discard n points to have samples of the peak

Burn-in = 200

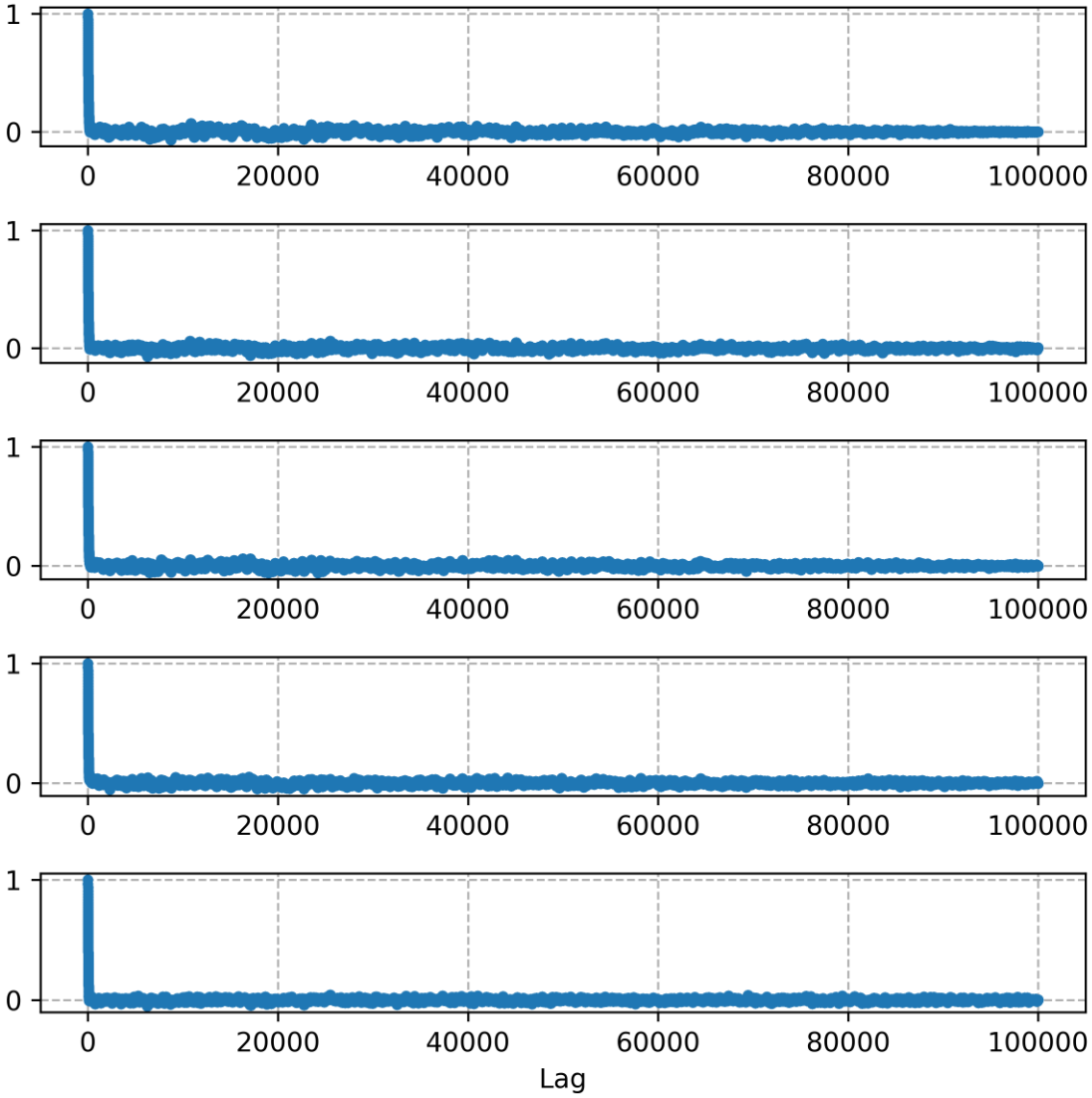




Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: autocorrelation

We look at the autocorrelation for the parameters and we see that for small lag the samples are correlated

Thinning: take a point every n to have not correlated samples



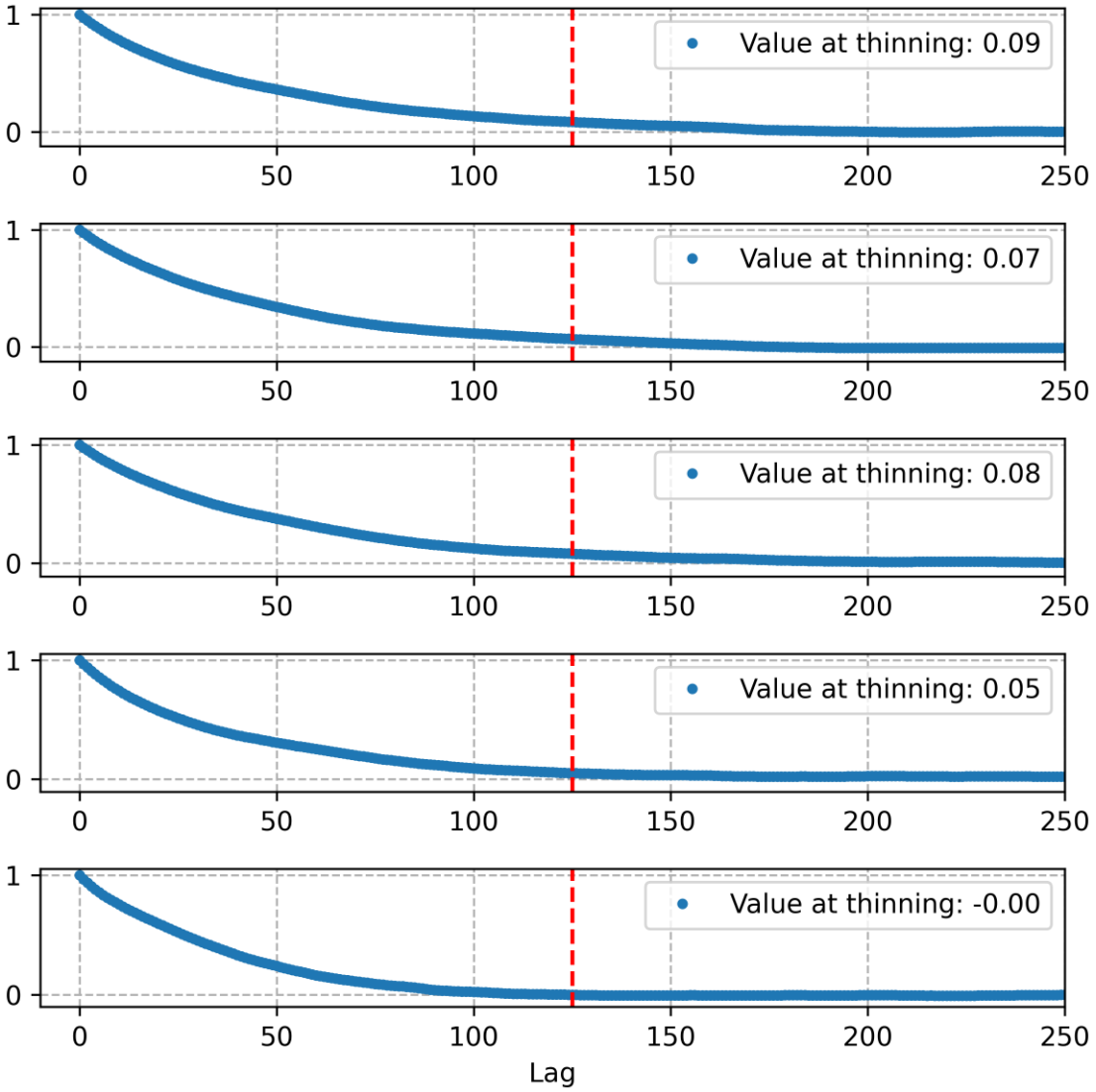
Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: autocorrelation

We look at the autocorrelation for the parameters and we see that for small lag the samples are correlated

Thinning: take a point every n to have not correlated samples

Thinning = 125

Remaining samples = 799



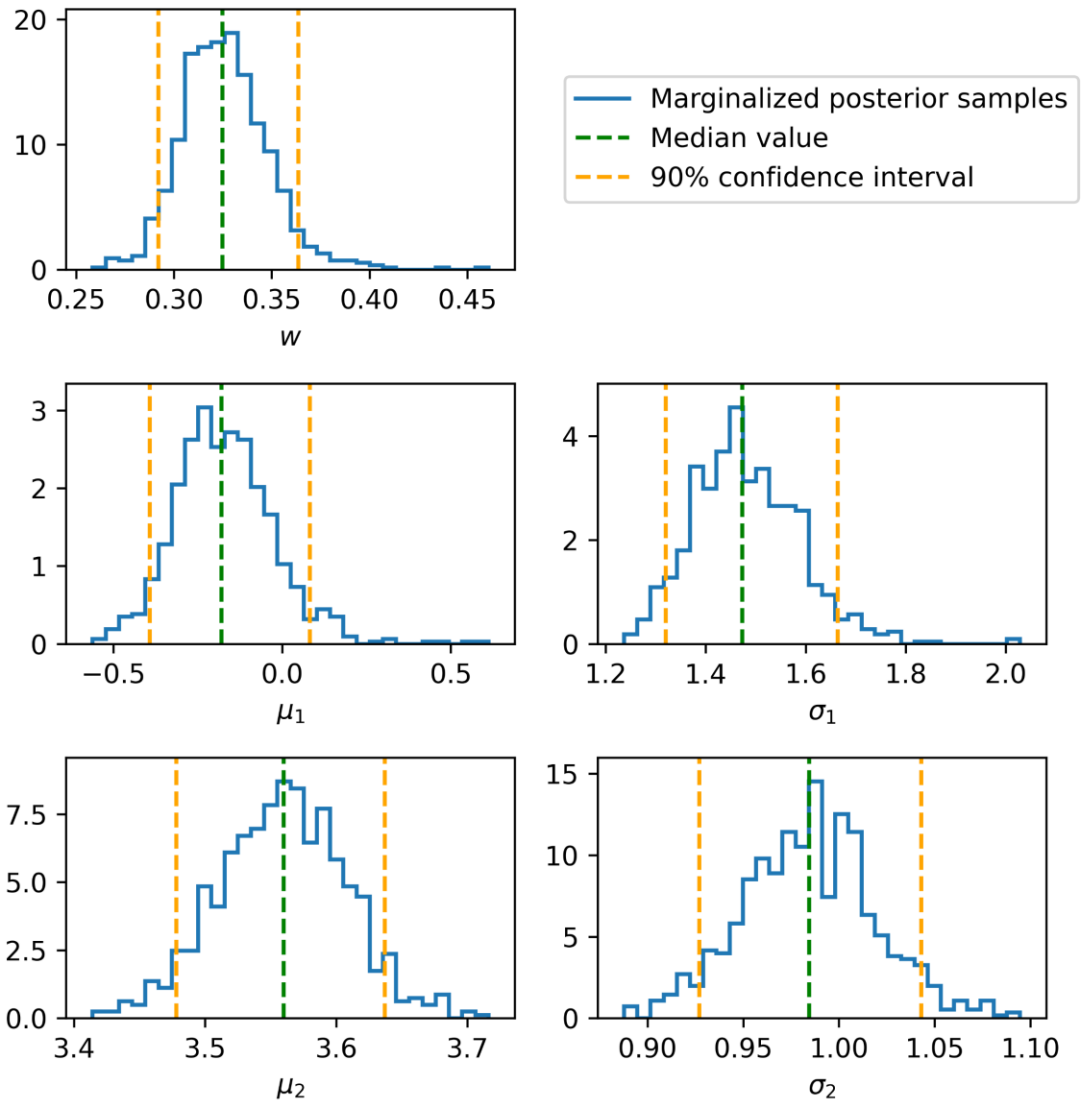
Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: marginals

We make the histograms for each parameter
We find the median value and the interval corresponding to 90% level of confidence

w
$0.325^{+0.039}_{-0.033}$

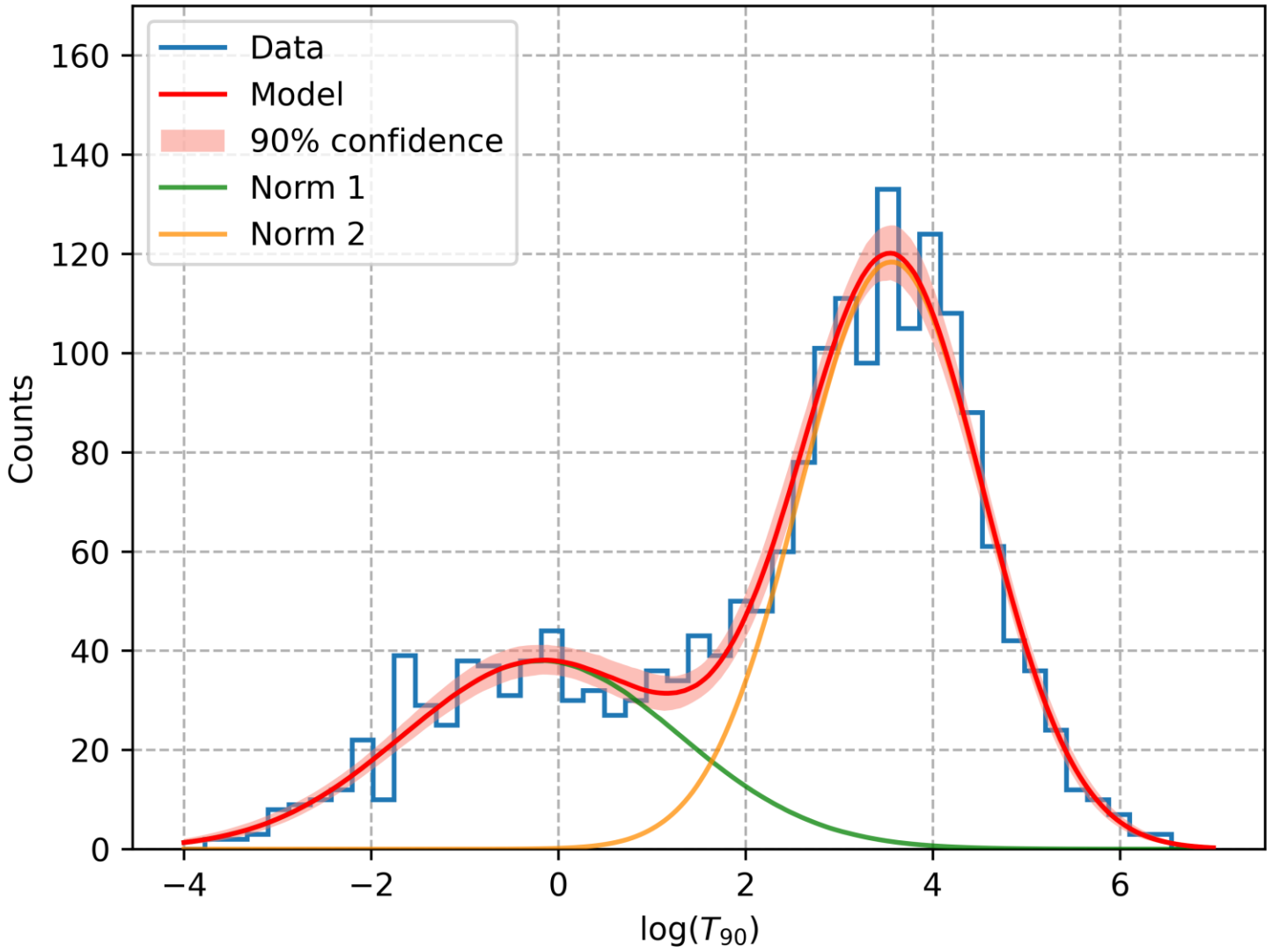
μ_1	σ_1
$-0.18^{+0.26}_{-0.21}$	$1.47^{+0.19}_{-0.15}$

μ_2	σ_2
$3.560^{+0.077}_{-0.082}$	$0.984^{+0.058}_{-0.057}$



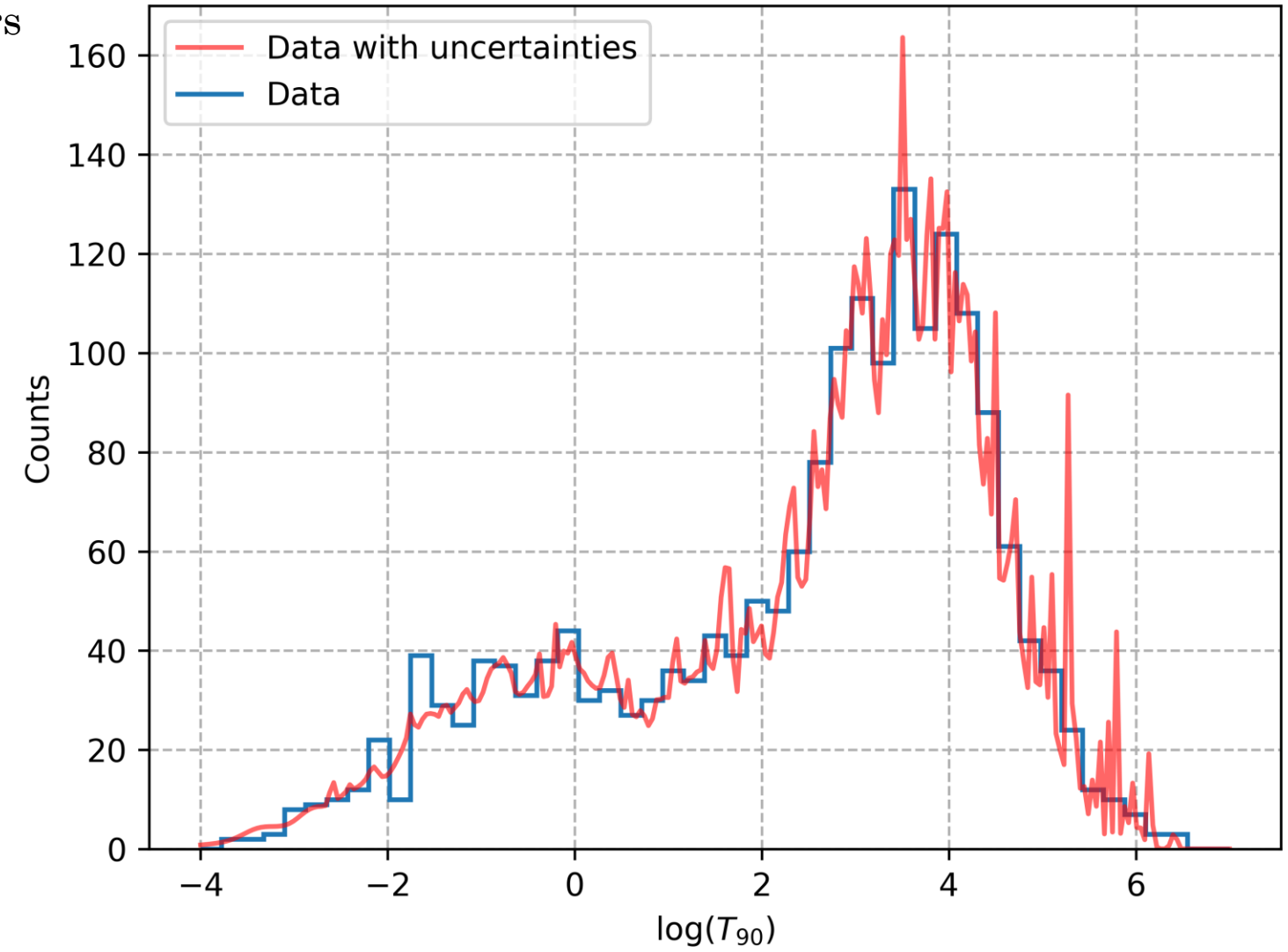
Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: final model

The final model, the median of the models computed on each sample



Classification on $\log(T_{90})$ with errors

Now consider the errors as gaussian errors on each measure



To visualize the data we sum all the gaussian $N(\log(T_{90})_i, \sigma_i)$, we normalize and scale to the binned data

Classification on $\log(T_{90})$ with errors

- Same model
- Same prior
- Same Metropolis Hasting Algorithm
- Different likelihood!

Given the uncertainties we can't histogram the data and we have to consider each measure as a realization from a gaussian with unknown mean

Calling $\log(T_{90}) = x$

$$\mathcal{L}_i = \int p(x_t|\theta) \cdot N(x_i|x_t\sigma_i)dx_t$$

Probability from the model of having x_t

Probability of measuring x_i given the mean x_t

Classification on $\log(T_{90})$ with errors

- Same model
- Same prior
- Same Metropolis Hasting Algorithm
- Different likelihood!

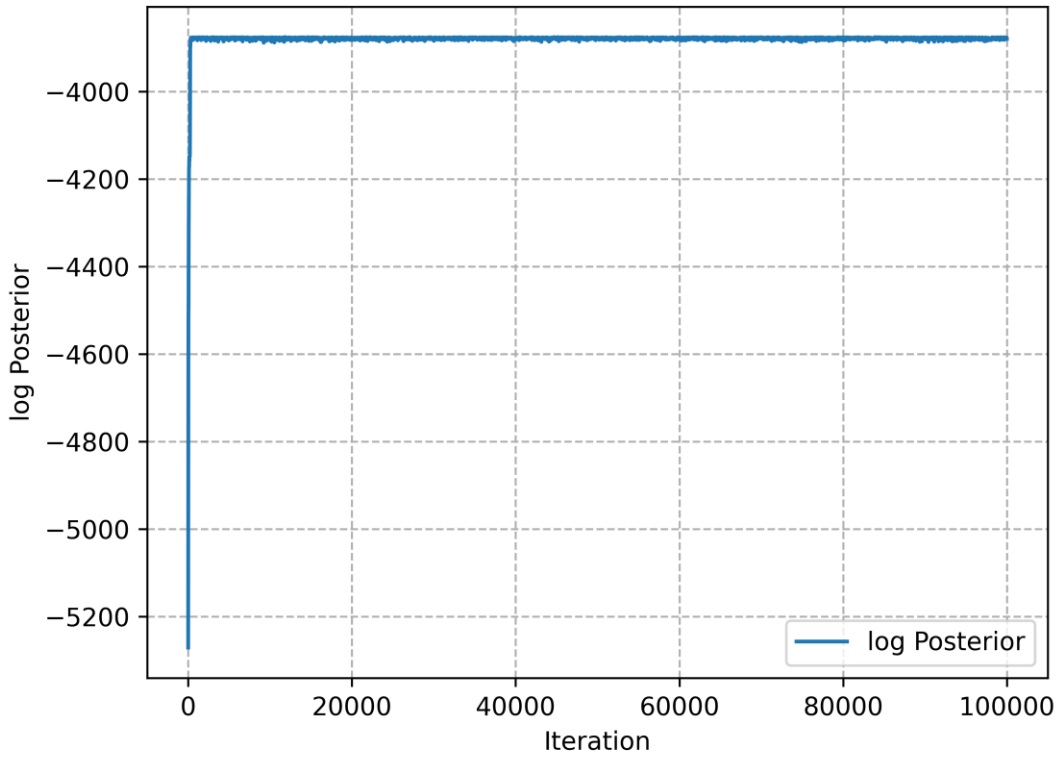
$$\mathcal{L}_i = \int p(x_t|\theta) \cdot N(x_i|x_t\sigma_i)dx_t$$

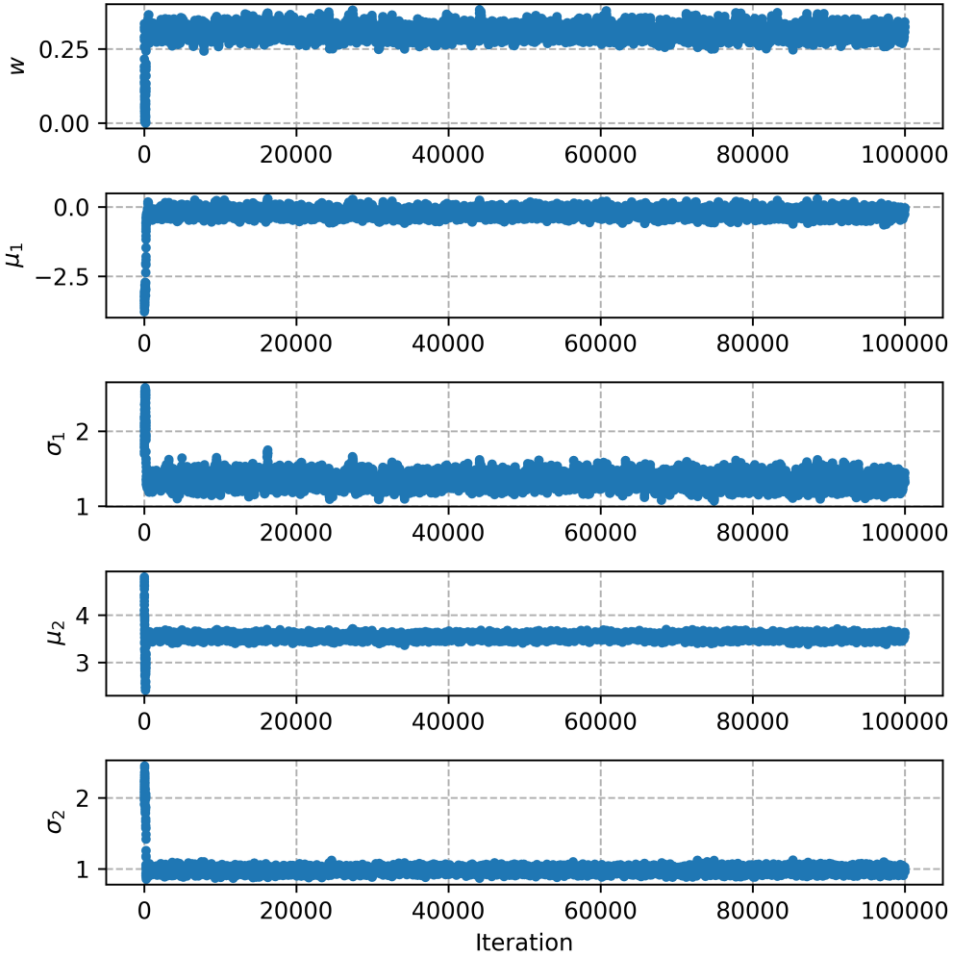
Fortunately our model is formed by gaussians so this integral is simply

$$\mathcal{L}_i = w \cdot N\left(x_i \middle| \mu_1, \sqrt{\sigma_1^2 + \sigma_i^2}\right) + (1-w) \cdot N\left(x_i \middle| \mu_1, \sqrt{\sigma_2^2 + \sigma_i^2}\right)$$

And the final likelihood will be the sum over the number of measure

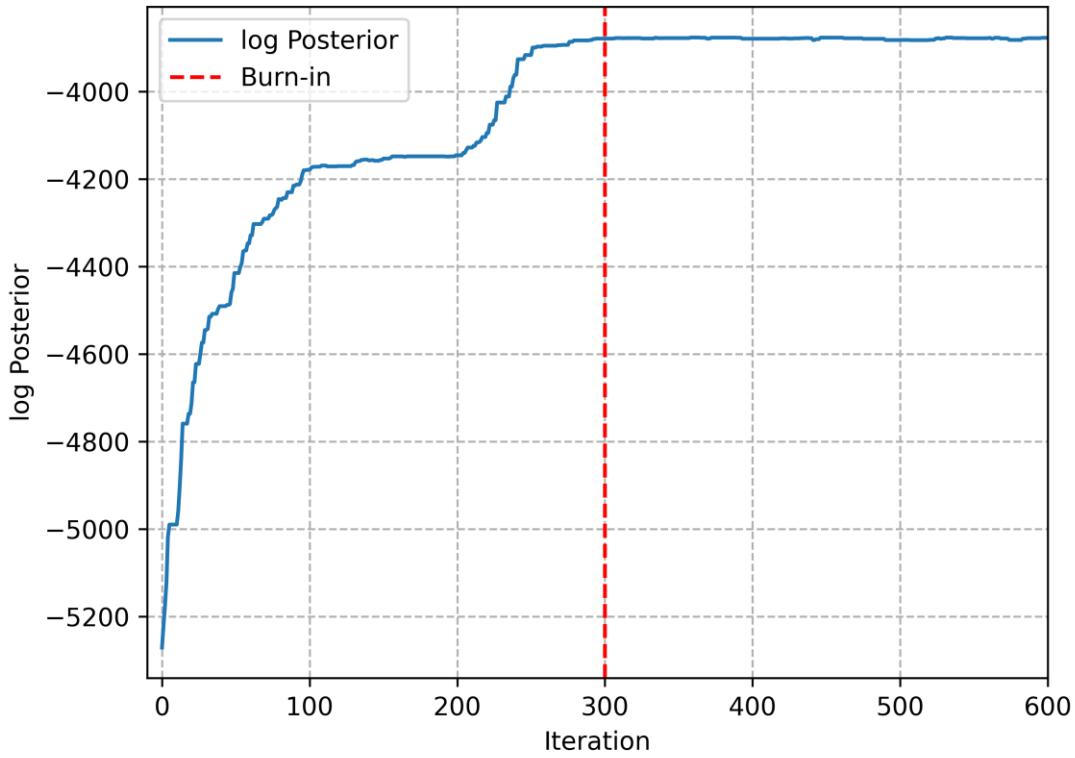
Classification on $\log(T_{90})$ with errors

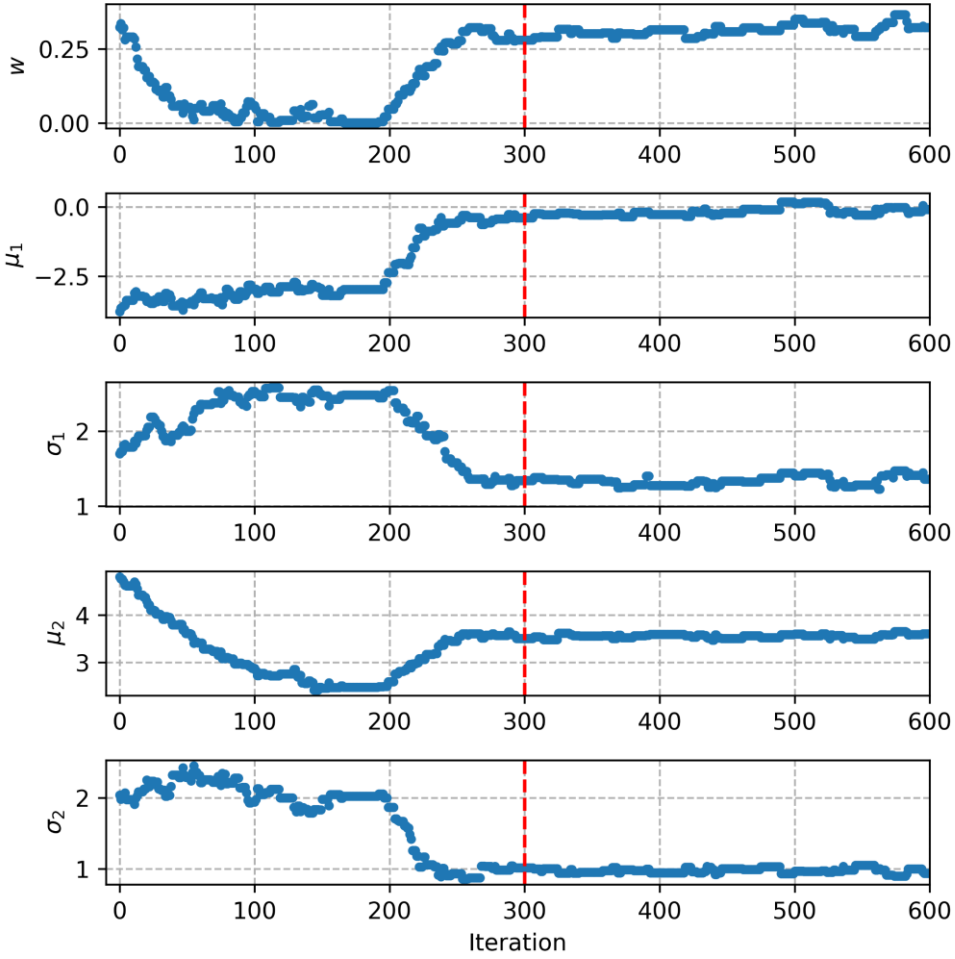




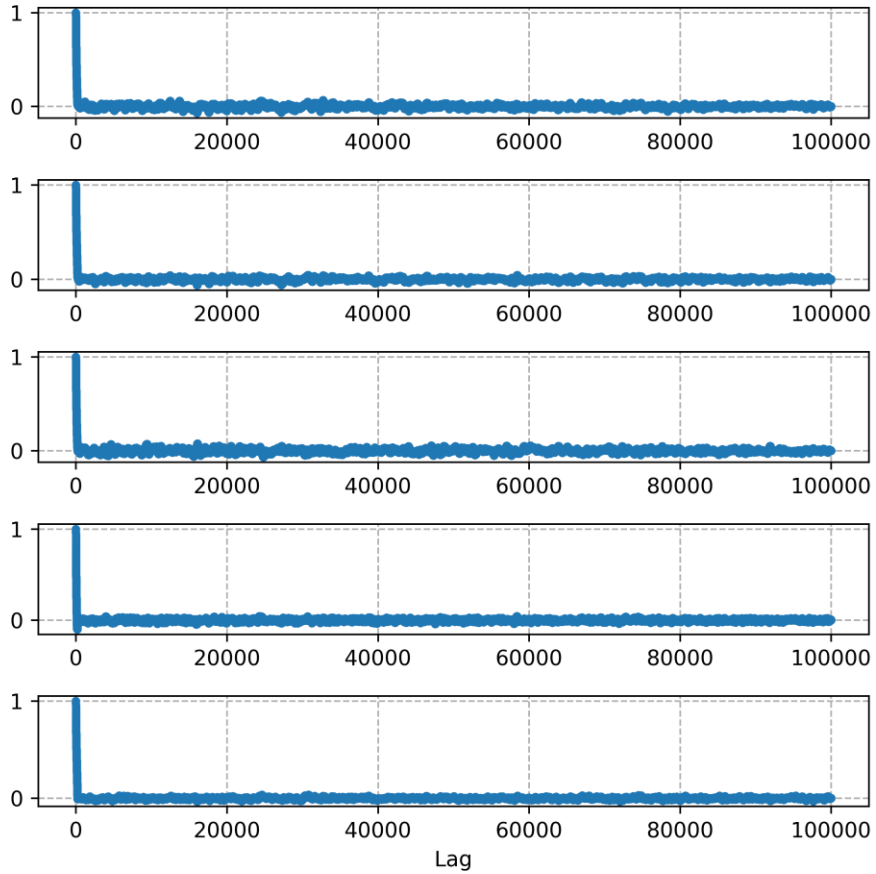
Classification on $\log(T_{90})$ with errors

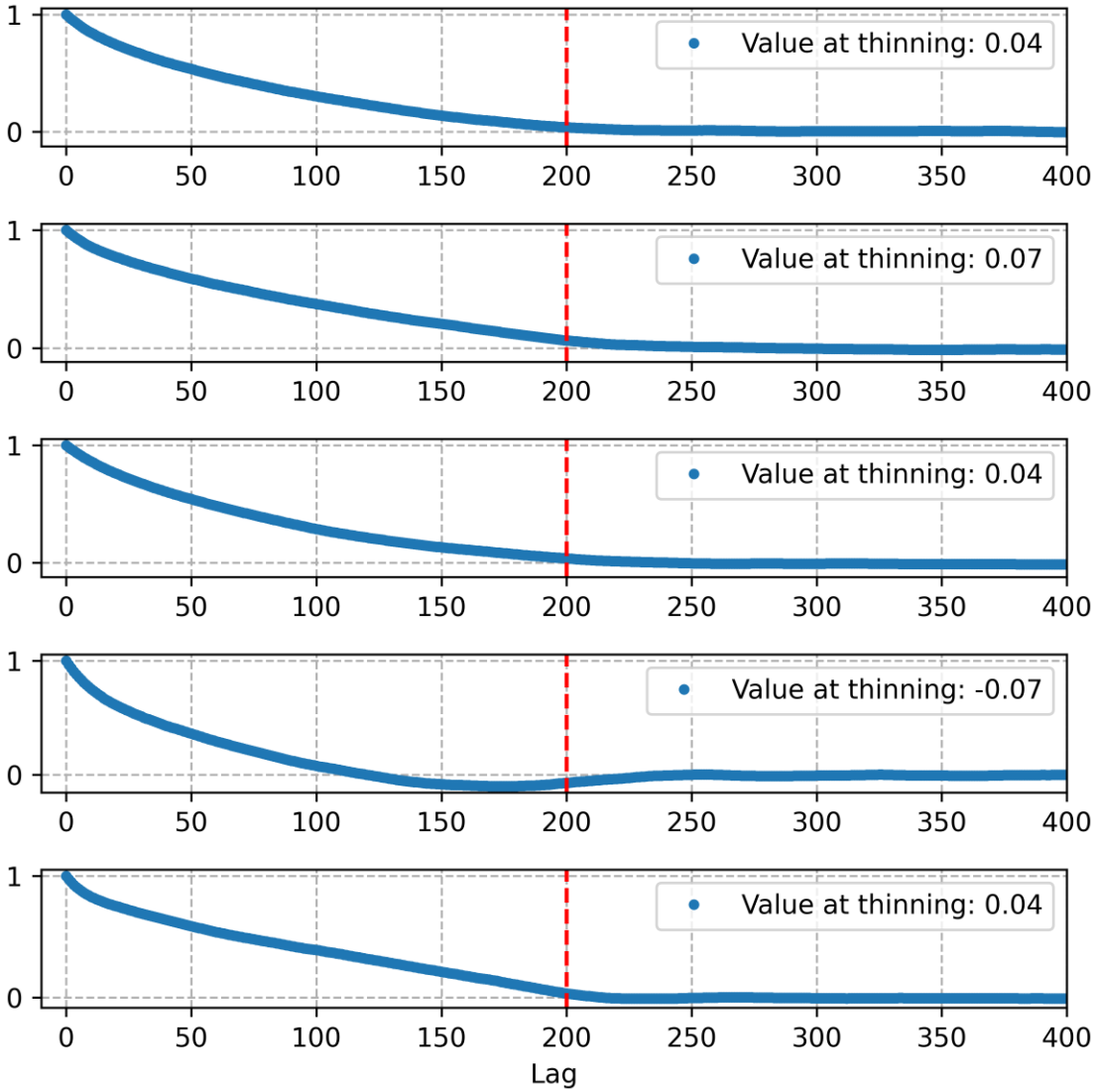
Burn-in = 300





Classification on $\log(T_{90})$ with errors





Thinning = 200

Remaining samples = 499

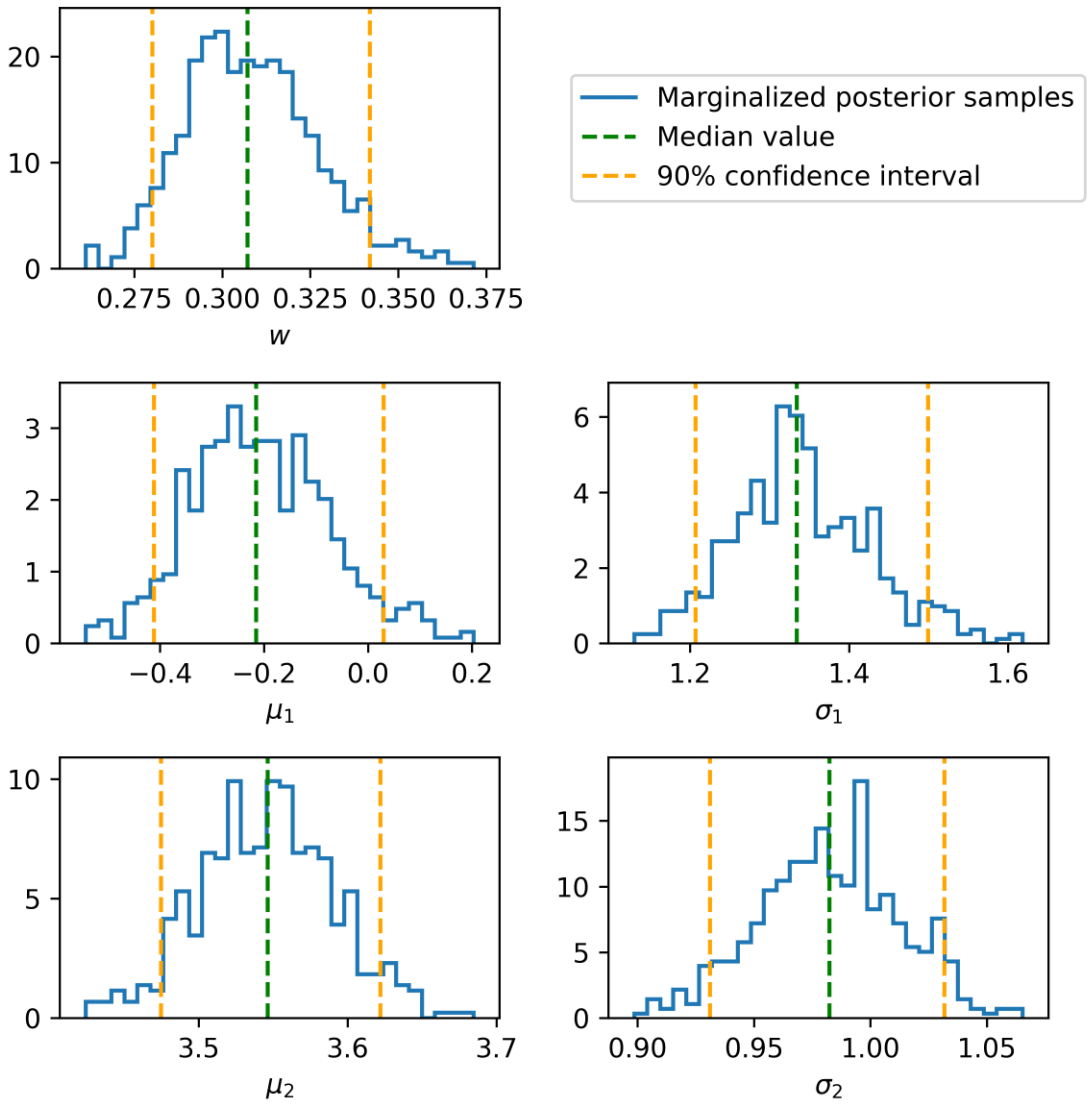
Classification on $\log(T_{90})$ with errors

We make the histograms for each parameter
We find the median value and the interval corresponding to 90% level of confidence

w
$0.307^{+0.035}_{-0.027}$

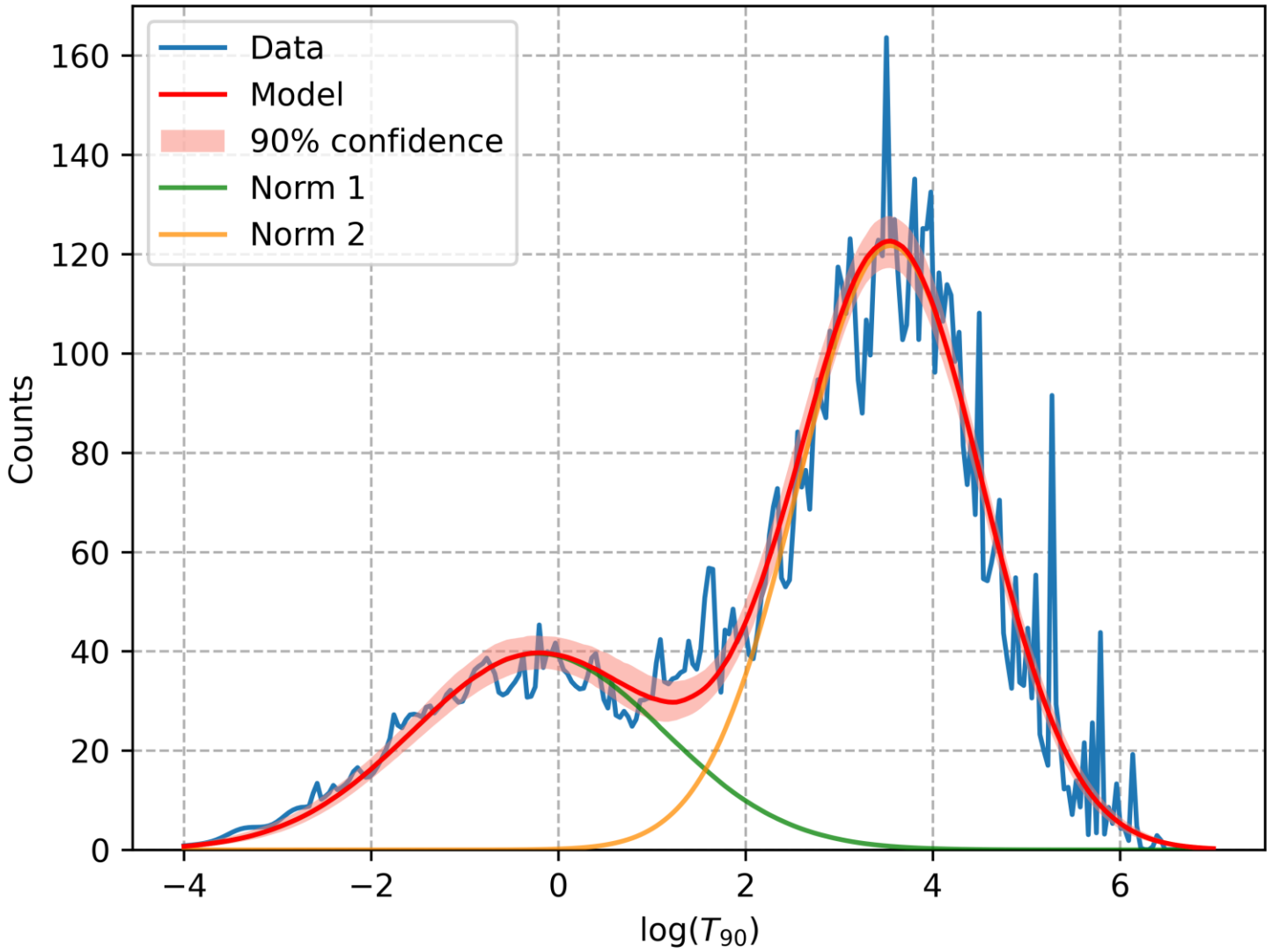
μ_1	σ_1
$-0.22^{+0.24}_{-0.19}$	$1.33^{+0.16}_{-0.13}$

μ_2	σ_2
$3.546^{+0.076}_{-0.072}$	$0.982^{+0.049}_{-0.051}$

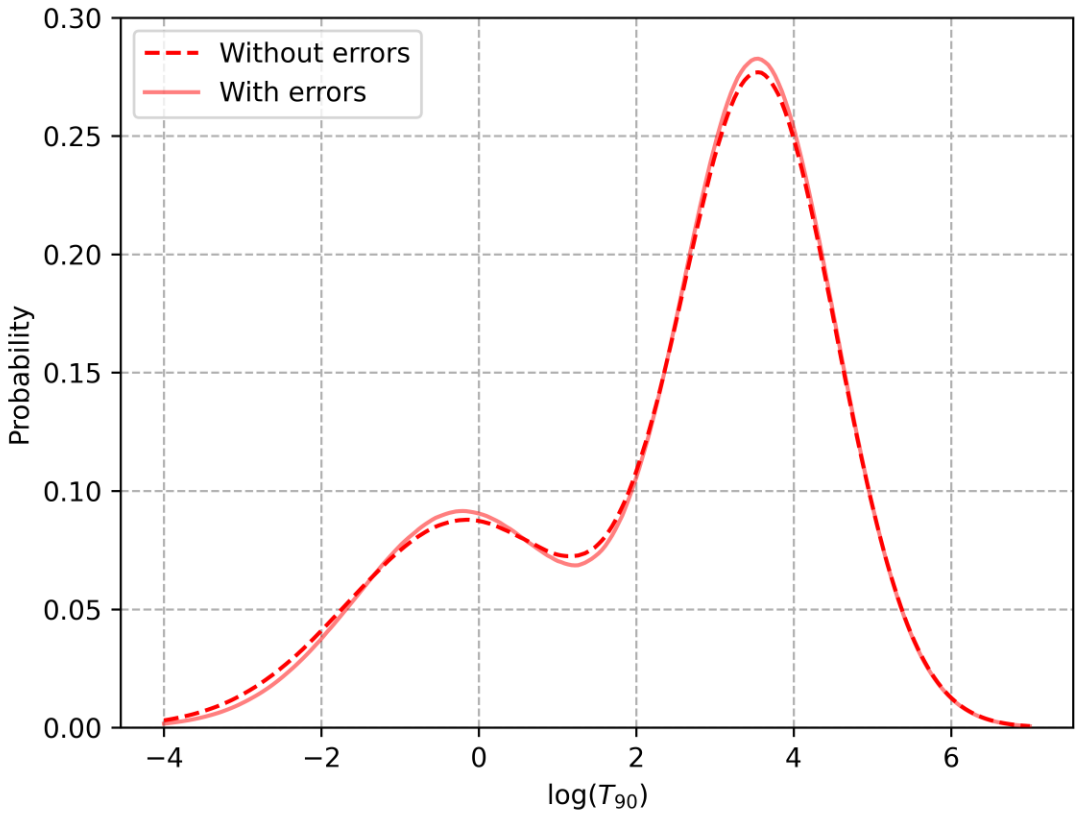


Classification on $\log(T_{90})$ with errors

The final model, the median of the models computed on each sample

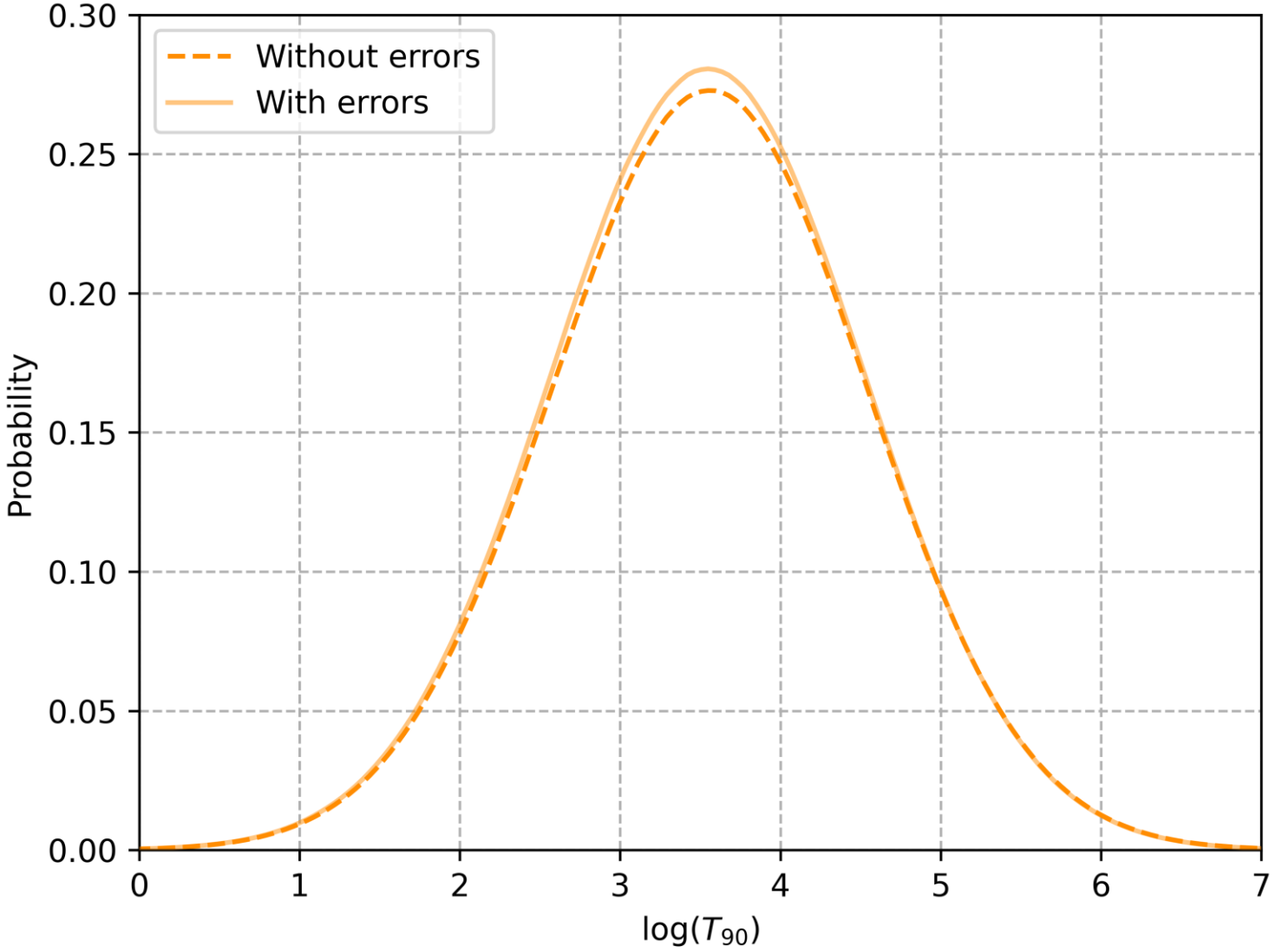


Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: differences

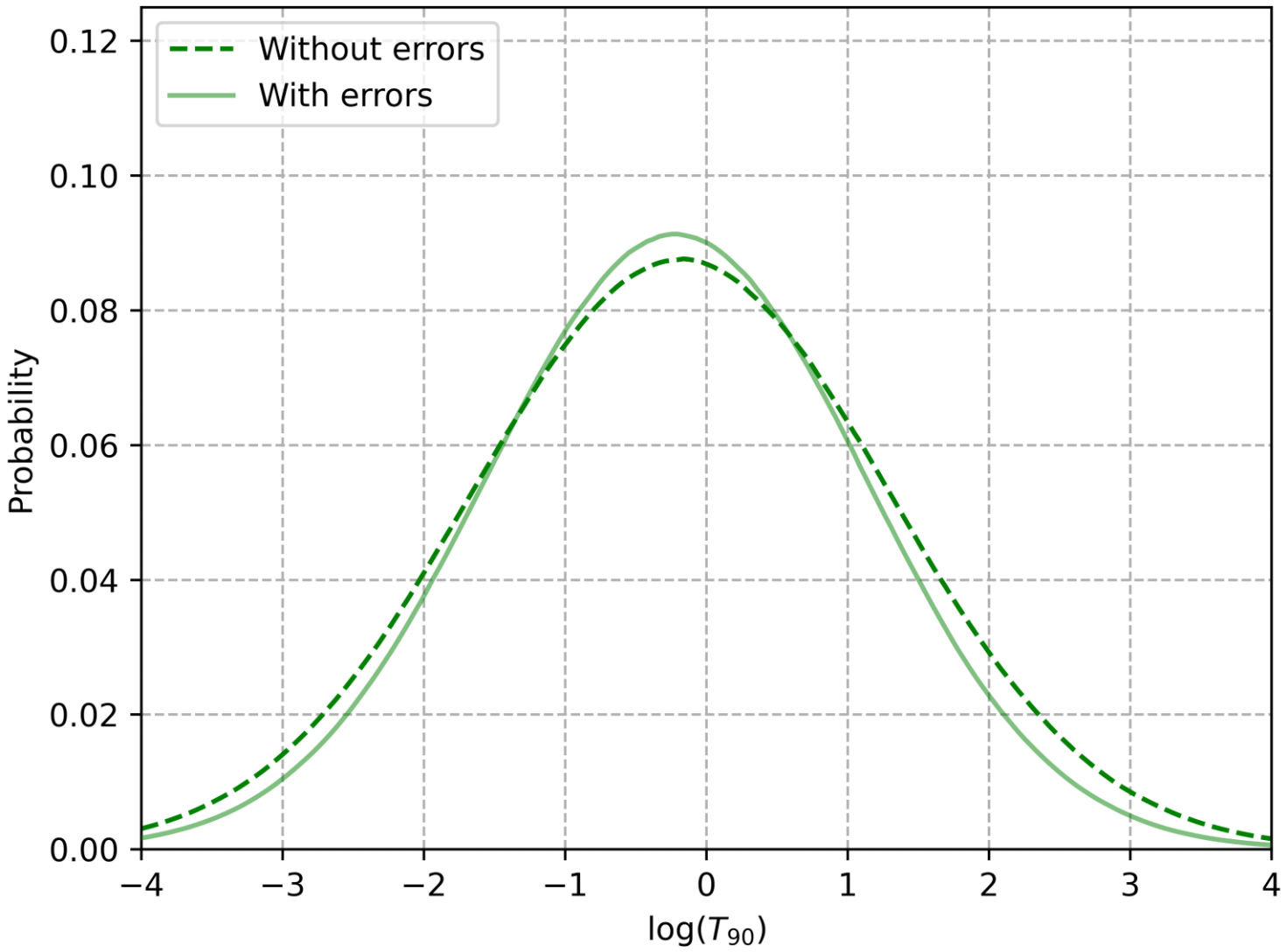


	w	μ_1	σ_1	μ_2	σ_2
Without errors	$0.325^{+0.039}_{-0.033}$	$-0.18^{+0.26}_{-0.21}$	$1.47^{+0.19}_{-0.15}$	$3.560^{+0.077}_{-0.082}$	$0.984^{+0.058}_{-0.057}$
With errors	$0.307^{+0.035}_{-0.027}$	$-0.22^{+0.24}_{-0.19}$	$1.33^{+0.16}_{-0.13}$	$3.546^{+0.076}_{-0.072}$	$0.982^{+0.049}_{-0.051}$

Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: differences



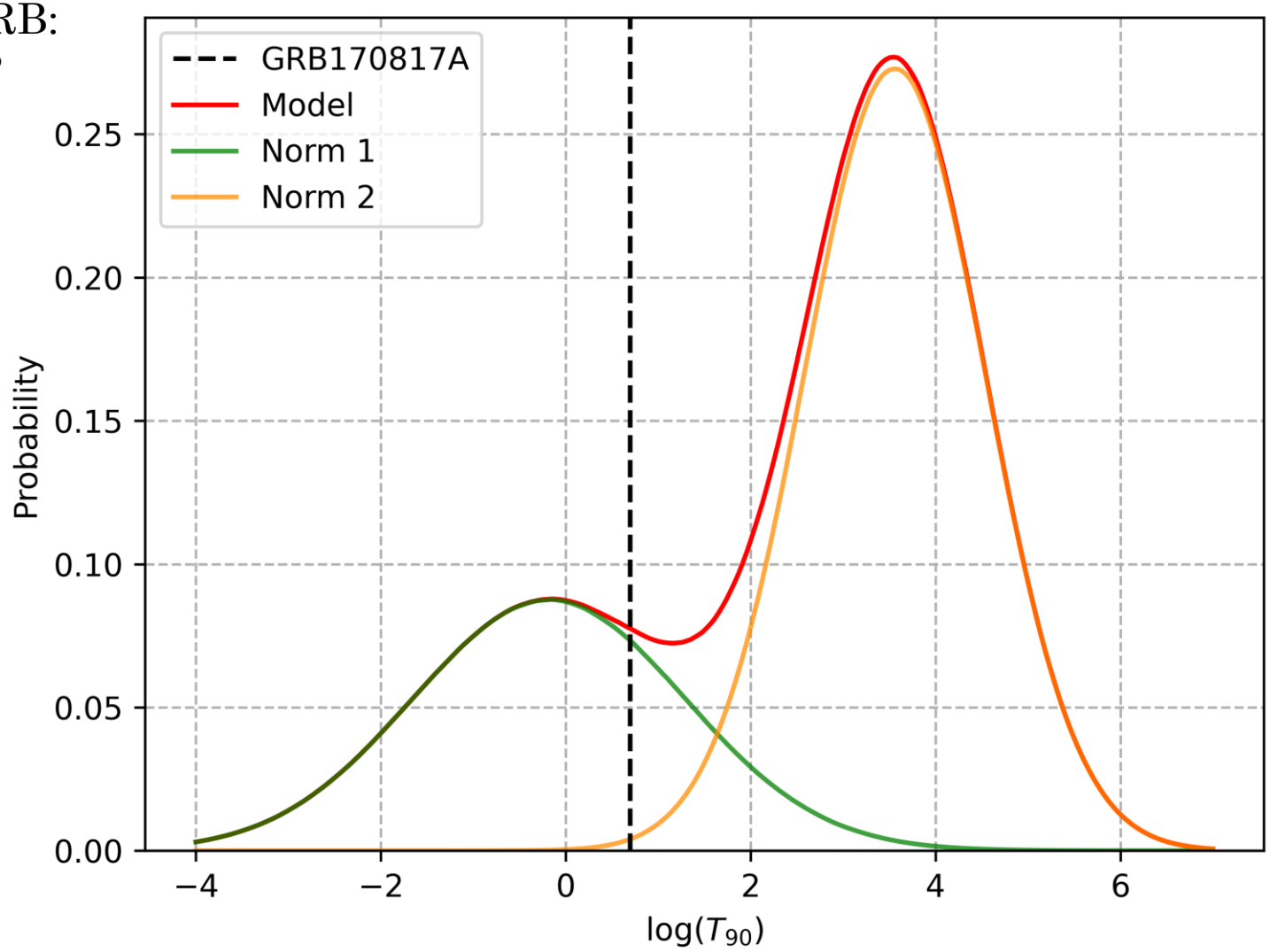
Classification on $\log(T_{90})$: differences



Classification of a GRB

We now look at the problem of classifying a single GRB: it's a short or long GRB?

Case study of GRB170817A, $T_{90} = 2.0$ s



Classification of a GRB

We will once again use Bayes theorem, start defining the propositions

- T = «The GRB has this T_{90}»
- S = «The GRB is a short GRB»
- L = «The GRB is a long GRB»
- I = «Model we found (without errors) and all the background information on GRBs»

So for the short:

$$P(S|TI) = P(S|I) \cdot \frac{P(T|SI)}{P(T|I)}$$

And the long:

$$P(L|TI) = P(L|I) \cdot \frac{P(T|LI)}{P(T|I)}$$

Classification of a GRB

Priors on the two classes: probability that is short/long given the model

$$P(S|I) = w$$

$$P(L|I) = 1 - w$$

It's the weight of the two components

As expected they sum to 1, they are exhaustive proposition

Classification of a GRB

Priors on the two classes: probability that is short/long given the model

$$P(S|I) = w$$

$$P(L|I) = 1 - w$$

It's the weight of the two components

As expected they sum to 1, they are exhaustive proposition

Likelihood on the two classes: probability that is short/long given the model and a T_{90}

$$P(S|TI) = N(\log(T_{90})\,|\mu_1\ \sigma_1)$$

$$P(L|TI) = N(\log(T_{90})\,|\mu_2\ \sigma_2)$$

It's the two normal distributions evaluated at the given T_{90}

Classification of a GRB

Normalization constant for the two classes: probability of having a T_{90} given the model

$$P(T|I) = p(\log(T_{90})\,|\theta)$$

It's the total model evaluated at the given T_{90}

Putting together this pieces we obtain for GRB170817A

$$P(S|TI) = 95\%$$

$$P(L|TI) = 5\%$$

So for our model it's a short GRB.

At which T_{90} we start to change class?

Conclusions

-

Bibliography??

Grazie per l’attenzione